

Jonathan Eaton, PhD

Socio-cultural Anthropologist

Disaster Resilience Research Network
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CURRENT POSITION

Executive Director, Disaster Resilience Research Network, and Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Civil Engineering, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

EDUCATION

- 2025 **PhD in Anthropology, University of British Columbia (UBC)**
Dissertation title: Anticipating disaster: Uncertainty, heritage, and place-making in Vancouver, Canada (<https://doi.org/10.14288/1.0447124>)
Supervisor: Dr. Sara Shneiderman
- 2011 **Master of Arts in Anthropology, University of Toronto**
MRP title: Trauma and Recovery: Re-Signifying Communist-era Sites of Memory in Contemporary Albania
Supervisor: Dr. Lena Mortensen
- 2009 **Bachelor of Arts in History, summa cum laude, Valparaiso University**
Valparaiso, Indiana
Minors in Humanities and Classical Languages
Christ College Scholar (interdisciplinary honors program)
International Studies Program in Cambridge, UK

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am a socio-cultural anthropologist with a focus on heritage, the anthropology of space and place, and the anthropology of disaster. My dissertation research studied the relationship between heritage and disaster recovery planning in Vancouver. My ethnography describes how building community and cultivating a sense of place can help people preserve what they value in the face of uncertain futures – highlighting strategies that communities can apply today to set the stage for future recovery. My past experience as a Fulbright scholar and heritage practitioner in Albania with the organization Cultural Heritage without Borders taught me to appreciate the importance of everyday moments connecting people and place.

Keywords: Heritage, space and place, values, urban/disaster planning, disaster recovery, uncertainty, futures, natural hazards, human-nonhuman relations, Vancouver, Canada

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed articles

- 2024 The state of disaster and resilience literature in British Columbia, Canada. A systematic scoping review. *International Journal of Disaster Risk Reduction* 113. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijdrr.2024.104848> (with C. Milne, T. Legere, S. Shneiderman, C. Molina Hutt)
- 2022 Heritage Languages and Language as Heritage: The Language of Heritage in Canada and Beyond. *International Journal of Heritage Studies* 28(7). <https://doi.org/10.1080/13527258.2022.2077805> (with M. Turin)
- 2014 Chiseling away at a concrete legacy: Engaging with Communist-era heritage and memory in Albania. *Journal of Field Archaeology* 39(3), 312-319. <https://doi.org/10.1179/0093469014Z.00000000084> (with E. Roshi)

Book chapters

- 2022 Austrian Economics on Mushrooms: A Mycelial Approach to Understanding Market Processes in Pre-Disaster Recovery Planning in Vancouver, Canada. In *Market Process and Market Order: Key Contributions*. Eds. Christopher Coyne, Rosolino Candela and Kristen Collins. Lanham, MD: Rowman & Littlefield.
- 2022 Acting Out the Future of the Albanian National Theatre: New Heritage at the Intersection of Resistance and New Media. In *Theorizing Heritage through Non-Violent Resistance*. Eds. Evren Uzer and Feras Hammami. London: Palgrave, 41-69. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-77708-1_3 (with K. Rocker)
- 2017 Rebuilding the Broken: Regional Restoration Camps as a Meeting Platform in the Western Balkans. In *Heritage and Peacebuilding*. Eds. Diana Walters, Daniel Laven and Peter Davis. Suffolk, UK: Boydell & Brewer, 205-219. (with L. Hadžić)

Reviews

- 2021 Living with Earthquakes, Past and Future. Review of *Shake Up* and *A Future for Memory*, Museum of Anthropology, University of British Columbia. *Visual Anthropology Review* 37(2), 463-469. <https://doi.org/10.1111/var.12252>

Conference proceedings

- 2018 Heritage-making and Democratic Ideals in Albania: Spaç Prison as a Site of Dialogue. New Delhi, India. *Proceedings of the 19th ICOMOS General Assembly and Scientific Symposium*. (with M. Bllaci, N. Petri, L. Hadžić, and E. Mamani)

- 2018 Hands-on Cooperation: The Regional Restoration Camps Experience in the Balkans. New Delhi, India. *Proceedings of the 19th ICOMOS General Assembly and Scientific Symposium*. (with L. Hadžić, E. Mamani, M. Bllaci, and R. Eppich)
- 2014 Restoration, Reconciliation, Hopes for the Future: Cultural Heritage without Borders – 17 years in the Western Balkans. In *The Politics of Heritage and Memory*. Zagreb: University of Zagreb. (with L. Hadžić)

Other publications

- 2025 Understanding Disaster Preparedness in Vancouver: Community Perspectives”. Vancouver: UBC Disaster Resilience Research Network (DRRN) and the City of Vancouver Emergency Management Agency (VEMA). doi: [10.14288/1.0450052](https://doi.org/10.14288/1.0450052) (with R. Somani, H. C. Ip, M. Hooper, T. Lim, and S. Shneiderman)
- 2023 As we fight the Alberta and B.C. wildfires, we must also plan for future disasters. *The Conversation*. May 19. <https://theconversation.com/as-we-fight-the-alberta-and-b-c-wildfires-we-must-also-plan-for-future-disasters-205818> (with S. Shneiderman)
- 2016 The Consequences of Neglect: Confronting Neglected Heritage as an Integral Part of Emergency Preparedness and Response. *e-dialogos* 5, 42-51.
- 2016 A Dialogue Toolkit: Tips and Techniques from the Dialogues for Spaç Project. Cultural Heritage without Borders-Albania and the International Coalition of Sites of Conscience. Available at: <https://www.sitesofconscience.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/08/Spac-Toolkit-2017-Final.pdf> (with M. Bllaci, N. Petri, and K. Rocker)
- 2015 Guide for First Aid on Built Heritage in Kosovo. Prishtina, Kosovo: SAS. (with Gj. Hoxha, I. Mejzini, F. Caka, Y. Vokshi, S. Boshtrakaj, V. Aliu, A. Tandon, R. Jigyasu and M. Jaramillo Contreras)
- 2015 Overview Report of the Nepal Cultural Emergency Crowdmap Initiative. Available at: <https://www.iccrom.org/news/nepal-cultural-emergency-report> (with colleagues from ICCROM and ICOMOS-ICORP)
- 2015 Tirana: Life After Demolition. *Clog: Landmark*. (with S. Battisti)
- 2010 Voice of the Western Balkans, Voice of Europe. *Tirana Times*, 7. (with T. Hashimoto and M. Dulaku)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2024 -	Mixed-methods, interdisciplinary study on emergency preparedness and risk perception in Vancouver, in partnership with the City of Vancouver Emergency Management Agency
2020 - 2021	Ethnographic dissertation fieldwork in Vancouver, Canada, "Anticipating disaster: Uncertainty, heritage, and place-making in Vancouver"
2019 - 2020	Research Assistant, "Expertise, Labour and Mobility in Nepal's Post-Conflict, Post-Disaster Reconstruction," University of British Columbia
2018 - 2020	Research Assistant, "From Nepal to Vancouver: An Ethnographic Scoping Exercise & Knowledge Exchange Event about Earthquakes, Heritage & Governance," University of British Columbia
2019	Pre-dissertation scoping fieldwork in Nepal and Louisiana
2018	Research Assistant, "Connecting South Asian & Himalayan Research Communities Across Cascadia," University of British Columbia
2009 - 2010	Fulbright Scholar (Albania), MA fieldwork on communist-era heritage
2008	Library Research Assistant / Smithsonian Institution Katzenberger Intern, Cooper-Hewitt National Design Museum, New York, NY

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2025 -	Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Department of Civil Engineering, and Executive Director, Disaster Resilience Research Network (DRRN), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2024 - 2025	Consulting for the International Centre for the Study of the Preservation and Restoration of Cultural Property (ICCROM), First Aid and Resilience for Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis (FAR) program
2022 - 2024	Coordinator, Disaster Resilience Research Network (DRRN), University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada
2023 - 2024	Consulting for Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania (CHWB-Albania) on "The Drino Valley Monasteries Cultural Routes: Connecting Rural Communities"
2012 - 2018	Program Officer, Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania (CHWB), Tirana, Albania
2011 - 2012	Museum Consultant, Gjirokastra Conservation and Development Organization, Gjirokastra, Albania

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2022	UBC Department of Anthropology Dissertation Writing Award (\$5,000 CAD)
2019 - 2022	Vanier Canada Graduate Scholarship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (\$150,000 CAD)
2019 - 2022	UBC Public Scholars Initiative (\$6,000 CAD)
2018 - 2023	UBC Four Year Fellowships (FYF) For PhD Students
2020 - 2021	UBC President's Academic Excellence Initiative PhD Award
2019 - 2021	Adam Smith Fellowship, Mercatus Center, George Mason Univ. (\$11,000 USD)
2019	UBC Faculty of Arts Graduate Student Research Award (\$1,000 CAD)
2018 - 2019	UBC Faculty of Arts Graduate Award (\$23,000 CAD)
2015	Andreas Ådahl Scholarship (5,000 SEK [Swedish Krona])
2011 - 2012	American Councils Title VIII Southeast European Language and Research Fellowship (\$10,500 USD)
2010 - 2011	University of Toronto Faculty of Arts and Sciences Graduate Studies Fellowship (\$17,500 CAD)
2009 - 2010	J. William Fulbright Award, Albania (\$15,000 USD)
2009	Joseph-Armand Bombardier Canada Graduate Scholarship - Master's (declined)
2009	Marvel Stockwell Scholarship from Pi Gamma Mu (\$2,000 USD)

AWARDS AND HONORS

2025	Hazards and Disasters Student Paper Competition, Natural Hazards Center, University of Colorado - Winner
2025	Erve Chambers Heritage & Tourism Student Paper Award - Honorable Mention
2014	European Union Prize for Cultural Heritage / Europa Nostra Award in the category of "Education, Training and Awareness-raising" (with CHwB-Albania)
2011	Best graduate student paper. World Archaeological Congress, Inter-Congress. June 22 - 25. Indianapolis, IN, USA
2009	Phi Beta Kappa, academic honor society, Valparaiso University, USA

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS AND WORKSHOPS

Conferences & panels organized

- 2025 Panel organizer and chair. The Future is a Foreign Country: Operationalizing and Acting on the World to Come. American Anthropological Association (AAA) Annual Meeting. November 19-23. New Orleans, LA.
- 2021 Conference organizer and session chair. Un/Predictable Environments: Politics, Ecology, Agency. International virtual conference. May 20-21. Vancouver, Canada. Supervised 4 staff.
- 2014 - 2017 Conference organizer and facilitator. Balkan Museum Network Annual Conference "Meet, See, Do." Multi-day international conference. Tirana, Albania (2014); Novi Sad, Serbia (2015); Shkodra, Albania (2016); Prishtina, Kosovo (2017).

Workshops and seminars organized

- 2022 - 2025 UBC Disaster Resilience Research Network organizational planning workshops. December 2022, September 2023, April 2024, May 2025. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.
- 2024 Two-week Regional Restoration Camp on oral history and interpretive trails. Cultural Heritage without Borders, Gjirokastra, Albania.
- 2021 Emergency Response and Salvage for Cultural Institutions. BC Heritage Emergency Response Network (BC HERN). April 18 - 19. Virtual workshop.
- 2018 Connecting South Asian and Himalayan Research Communities Across Cascadia. November 2 - 3. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.
- 2018 Beyond the Grave: A Symposium on the Politics of Dead Bodies in (Post)Socialist Albania. Tirana, Albania.
- 2016 - 2018 CHwB Regional Restoration Camps. Two-week intensive hands-on heritage training. July 2016, July 2017, June 2018. Shkodra, Albania.
- 2016 International Course on Disaster Risk Management for Cultural Heritage. Balkan Cultural Aid Response for Emergencies (B+CARE). November 7 - 27. Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina; Prishtina, Kosovo; Gjirokastra, Albania.
- 2016 Volunteer Training on First Aid for Cultural Heritage. Balkan Cultural Aid Response for Emergencies (B+CARE). March 14 - 18. Gjirokastra, Albania.
- 2014 Dialogues for Spaç. Series of multi-day workshops. Documenting and understanding (June), Visioning (October), Planning (December)

Invited research talks

- 2025 Disaster Planning and Heritage: Imagining Earthquake Aftermaths in Vancouver. May 8. Vancouver Heritage Foundation. Vancouver, Canada.
- 2025 From Albania to Appleton and In Between: How to Use an Anthropology Degree (or Two). May 5. Lawrence Anthropology Society, Lawrence University. Appleton, WI
- 2022 Culture and Disasters: A View from Anthropology. November 16. Dunbar Earthquake and Emergency Preparedness (DEEP). Vancouver, Canada.
- 2021 Research presentation to City of Vancouver Sustainability Group. October 26. Vancouver, Canada.

Invited professional talks (for CHwB-Albania)

- 2018 Living communities, living heritage. Presentation and workshop. UNESCO World Heritage Youth Forum. June 18. Bahrain.
- 2018 From Mines to Mind-maps: A Dialogue-based Approach to Museum Planning at Spaç Prison. Network of European Museum Organizations (NEMO) Webinar. June 25. Tirana, Albania.
- 2018 Heritage-making for the Future: Unlocking Dialogue and Action at Spaç Prison. Widening the Debate on the Cultural Heritage of the Dictatorship in Albania. May 25. Tirana, Albania.
- 2016 Restoring and Building Relations: Heritage for Building Peace. International course on Building National Capacities in First Aid and Risk Management for Cultural Heritage in Times of Conflict. October 30. ICCROM-ATHAR Regional Conservation Center, Sharjah, United Arab Emirates.
- 2016 Taking Action: First Aiders After FAC and Restoring and Building Relations: Planning for Post-Conflict Recovery. International course on First Aid for Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis. June 24. Washington, DC.
- 2016 Public debate: Heritage and Identity Politics in Wars and Conflicts. April 18. Gothenburg, Sweden.
- 2016 Lessons Learned from the Balkan Experience: Our Approach to Cultural Tourism. Regional Ecotourism Initiative. Community Ecotourism Training. March 3. Lotan, Israel.
- 2015 Heritage, Cross-cultural Conflict and Development: Lessons Learned from the Balkan Experience. Regional Ecotourism Initiative, Expert Meeting. February 13. Madaba, Jordan.

Conference presentations

- 2025 Heritage in Recovery: Shifting perspectives on making place amidst disaster potentiality in Vancouver, Canada. Society for Applied Anthropology (SfAA) Annual Meeting. March 25 - 29. Portland, OR.
- 2023 Retrofitting Vancouver: How Deep Earth and Deep Time Shape the City. American Anthropological Association (AAA) Annual Meeting. November 15-19. Toronto, ON.
- 2023 Converging Crises and Diverging Temporalities in Vancouver, Canada. Society for Applied Anthropology (SfAA) Annual Meeting. March 28-April 1. Cincinnati, OH.
- 2022 What is the greenest building? Imagining Housing, Heritage, and the Future of the Built Landscape in Vancouver, Canada. American Anthropological Association (AAA) Annual Meeting. November 9-13. Seattle, WA.
- 2021 Rebuilding the Future: Disaster Anticipation and Recovery Planning in Vancouver, Canada. The Northern European Conference on Emergency and Disaster Studies (NEEDS). September 21-23. Östersund, Sweden.
- 2021 Converging Crises and Seismic Uncertainty in Vancouver, Canada. Un/Predictable Environments: Politics, Ecology, Agency. May 20-21. Vancouver, Canada.
- 2019 Projecting dystopia: Art and the right to the city. American Anthropological Association (AAA) / Canadian Anthropology Society (CASCAS). November 20 - 24. Vancouver, Canada.
- 2017 Balkan Cultural Aid Response for Emergencies (B+CARE). First Aid for Culture Design Workshop. October 16 - 20. ICCROM, Rome, Italy.
- 2017 Heritage-making and Democratic Ideals in Albania: Spaç Prison as a Site of Dialogue. 19th ICOMOS General Assembly and Scientific Symposium. December 11 - 15. New Delhi, India.
- 2013 Challenges and Opportunities for Sustainable Cultural Heritage Regeneration in a Post-Conflict Kosovo. Annual conference of the International National Trust Organization. September 29 - October 3. Entebbe, Uganda.
- 2013 Restoration, Reconciliation, Hopes for the Future: Cultural Heritage without Borders: 17 Years in the Western Balkans. The Politics of Heritage & Memory. October 9. Zadar, Croatia.
- 2011 Museums, Indigeneity and Crises of Identity in the Western Balkans. World Archaeological Congress, Inter-Congress. June 22 - 25. Indianapolis, IN, USA.

2009 Understanding History: Interpreting the Past through the Interpretations of Others. National Conference on Undergraduate Research (NCUR). April 16 - 18. LaCrosse, WI, USA.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2025 ANTH110: Introduction to Cultural Anthropology, Instructor of Record, Department of Anthropology, Lawrence University, Appleton, WI

2022 ANTH100: Introduction to Cultural Anthropology, Graduate Teaching Assistant (planning, leading, and grading for 3 seminar-style tutorials, weekly), Department of Anthropology, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC

2010 - 2011 ANT204: Anthropology in the Contemporary World, Graduate Teaching Assistant (planning and leading tutorials, grading), Department of Anthropology, University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

SERVICE AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

2018 - Double blind peer review for *International Journal of Heritage Studies* (2), *Irish Journal of Anthropology* (2), *East European Politics and Societies* (1) and *Politics, Religion and Ideology* (1)

2018 - 2025 Anthropology Graduate Student Association (AGSA), University of British Columbia; Vice President (2020-2021); produced study and report on COVID-19 impacts on current graduate students; represented graduate students on task force to resolve role of students on tenure-track faculty hiring committees; mentored incoming graduate students, including 3 winners of the Vanier CGS and 1 winner of the Frédéric Bastiat Fellowship

2023 Co-organized a series of public “Reading Room” seminars on heritage and disasters with Heritage Vancouver Society

2022 Desk review and commentary on risk preparedness for UNESCO World Heritage nomination on behalf of ICOMOS-ICORP

2021 - 2022 General Volunteer, Emergency Support Services, Vancouver, BC

2019 - 2021 Reviewer of nominations for World Monument Fund Watch List

2018 Participant, “International Leadership Course on First Aid to Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis,” Brabant, Netherlands, 24-31 August, organized by ICCROM, Prince Claus Fund, Smithsonian Institution, and UNESCO Netherlands

2018 Participant in developmental evaluation of the Regional Restoration Camps, the

	flagship program of Cultural Heritage without Borders - Albania
2015	Participant, International Course "First Aid for Cultural Heritage in Times of Crisis," Amsterdam, Netherlands, 30 March - 24 April, organized by ICCROM, Prince Claus Fund, Smithsonian Institution, and UNESCO Netherlands
2012	External Reviewer, Fulbright/Humphrey Award Selection Committee, US Embassy in Albania

MEDIA COVERAGE

2022 -	Facilitated media engagement with members of UBC Disaster Resilience Research Network
2025	Interviewed for <i>CTV</i> and <i>The Conversation Lab</i>
2023	Published article in <i>The Conversation</i> (see 'Other publications') on disaster planning; republished by local independent news source <i>The Tyee</i>
2023	Interviewed on live radio on QR Calgary
2023	Interviewed for <i>Modern Farmer</i> article, titled "Canada's Wildfires Threaten Its Farmers From All Sides"

LANGUAGES

English (native) | **Albanian** (working fluency) | **Spanish** (intermediate)

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2022 -	Member, American Anthropological Association (AAA)
2022 -	Member, Society for Applied Anthropology (SfAA)
2016 -	Associate Member, ICOMOS International Committee on Risk Preparedness (ICORP)
2015 -	Member, International Council on Monuments and Sites (ICOMOS)